

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Certain species of fireflies synchronize their flashing patterns so that thousands of individuals blink in unison across a forest canopy. Biologist Maren Otsuka has proposed that this synchronization evolved as a means of reducing visual clutter: when all members of a species flash at the same moment, their signals are easier to distinguish from those of other species flashing at different intervals. If Otsuka's proposal is correct, synchronized flashing would primarily benefit fireflies in habitats where _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: several bioluminescent species with similar flash wavelengths occupy the same territory and are active during the same hours.

B: the species exhibiting synchronization also displays a wider variety of flash durations than most co-occurring species do.

C: individual fireflies within a synchronized population vary considerably in the brightness of their flashes.

D: ambient light levels are high enough that bioluminescent signals from any single species are difficult for potential mates to detect.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Otsuka says synchronization reduces 'visual clutter' from OTHER species. The correct completion must introduce a scenario with multiple overlapping species. Only A sets up that inter-species overlap. B and C focus on within-species variation, and D shifts to ambient light--a different problem entirely.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Economists have long measured national prosperity primarily through gross domestic product (GDP), which captures the total monetary value of goods and services a country produces. However, some researchers argue that GDP alone provides an incomplete picture, since it does not account for factors such as income inequality, environmental degradation, or citizens' subjective sense of fulfillment. These researchers therefore suggest that GDP _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: remains the most comprehensive metric available and should continue to serve as the sole indicator of national prosperity.

B: is a useful but insufficient indicator that should be supplemented with additional measures of well-being.

C: tends to overstate prosperity in developing nations while understating it in wealthier countries.

D: would more accurately reflect prosperity if it incorporated military spending and government debt into its calculations.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage says GDP is 'incomplete' but does NOT say it is useless. The answer must preserve GDP's value while adding to it. B does exactly this. A contradicts the researchers. C introduces a developed-vs-developing comparison absent from the text. D narrows to specific economic line items never mentioned.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Archaeologist Priya Sharma examined pottery fragments unearthed at a trading settlement along the ancient Silk Road. The chemical composition of the clay matched deposits found only near kilns in central China, yet the decorative motifs on the fragments resembled artistic traditions common in Persia during the same period. Sharma concluded that the pottery was most likely manufactured in China and then _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: sold exclusively to Chinese collectors who had developed an interest in Persian visual art.

B: fired at lower temperatures than was customary in Chinese kilns in order to preserve the Persian-style designs.

C: decorated with Persian-influenced designs before being shipped westward along trade routes.

D: copied by Persian artisans who had independently discovered the same clay-firing techniques.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Two facts--Chinese clay + Persian motifs. The completion must link both. C explains how Chinese-made pottery ended up with Persian designs. A contradicts 'trading settlement' (not Chinese collectors). B introduces firing-temperature details unsupported by the passage. D reverses the direction--the clay is Chinese, so Persian artisans did not make it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The axolotl, a salamander native to Lake Xochimilco in Mexico, retains its larval features throughout adulthood--a phenomenon known as neoteny. Unlike most amphibians, which undergo metamorphosis and transition to a terrestrial lifestyle, the axolotl remains fully aquatic, breathing through feathery external gills. Scientists believe this trait persisted because Lake Xochimilco's stable, resource-rich waters offered little advantage for a shift to land. This reasoning implies that neoteny in the axolotl is best understood as _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: a universal feature of salamander species that inhabit deep freshwater lakes in volcanic regions.

B: a temporary developmental stage that axolotls abandon if water conditions deteriorate significantly.

C: evidence that all amphibian species are capable of remaining permanently aquatic when food is abundant.

D: an adaptation shaped by the specific environmental conditions of the species' native habitat.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage links neoteny to Lake Xochimilco's SPECIFIC conditions. The answer must connect the trait to local environment. D captures this. A overgeneralizes to all salamanders. B contradicts 'throughout adulthood.' C overgeneralizes to all amphibians. Watch for 'all' and 'universal'--they almost always signal a wrong answer on inference questions.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Psychologist Elena Voss conducted a study in which participants were asked to evaluate the creativity of two nearly identical paintings. One painting was attributed to a well-known artist, while the other was attributed to an unknown art student. Participants consistently rated the painting attributed to the famous artist as more creative, even though the two paintings differed only in their attributed authorship. What does the text most strongly imply about the participants' evaluations?

A: Participants were unaware that the two paintings were nearly identical and based their ratings on genuine visual differences they perceived.

B: Participants rated the painting by the unknown student lower because they found its technique to be less accomplished than that of the famous artist.

C: Participants' judgments were shaped more by the perceived reputation of the creator than by observable qualities of the artwork itself.

D: Participants who had formal art training were less influenced by authorship attribution than those without such training.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The key phrase is 'differed only in their attributed authorship.' Since nothing else varied, the authorship label drove the ratings. C captures this. A contradicts 'nearly identical.' B assumes technique differences the passage explicitly rules out. D introduces a subgroup (trained vs untrained) the study never describes.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The mineral olivine is abundant in Earth's upper mantle but relatively uncommon on the planet's surface because it weathers rapidly when exposed to water and atmospheric carbon dioxide. Geologist David Henriksen noted that large surface deposits of olivine persist in certain arid regions of Oman, where rainfall is minimal and temperatures are extreme. Henriksen's observation most strongly implies that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the arid climate in those regions has slowed the chemical weathering process that would normally break down olivine.

B: olivine deposits in Oman formed more recently than surface olivine deposits found in other regions of the world.

C: the chemical composition of Oman's olivine differs from that of olivine found in Earth's upper mantle.

D: olivine weathers more quickly when exposed to extreme heat than when exposed to water and carbon dioxide.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage says olivine weathers via water + CO₂. Oman has minimal rainfall. Connect the two: low water = slow weathering = olivine persists. A makes this connection. B introduces age without support. C contradicts the premise (same mineral). D contradicts the passage--heat is present in Oman yet olivine survives, so heat is not the main weathering agent.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from a 1913 novel by Mitsuko Abe. The narrator, Haruki, has just returned to his childhood village after many years abroad. The village had shrunk. Not in any literal, measurable way--the hills still crouched at the same distances, and the creek still carved its old path behind the schoolhouse. But the buildings seemed to huddle closer together now, as though bracing against something invisible, and the streets that had once felt like vast avenues to a boy of seven could be crossed in a handful of adult strides. Haruki paused at the bridge and understood: nothing here had changed but himself. As presented in the text, Haruki would most likely agree with which statement?

A: The village has undergone subtle physical changes during his absence that are apparent only to someone who knew it as a child.

B: His perception of the village's size has changed because he himself has grown and gained broader experience.

C: Returning to a childhood home inevitably produces feelings of sadness and regret about the passage of time.

D: The village's residents have intentionally preserved the town's original layout to maintain its historical character.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: The last sentence is the key: 'nothing here had changed but himself.' This directly states the village is the same--Haruki changed. B matches. A says the village changed (contradicts the text). C introduces sadness/regret the passage never expresses. D is about residents' intentions, which the passage does not discuss.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Astronomers have observed that certain exoplanets orbiting red dwarf stars are tidally locked, meaning one hemisphere permanently faces the star while the other remains in perpetual darkness. Some researchers have speculated that such planets could still harbor liquid water if atmospheric circulation were strong enough to distribute heat from the illuminated side to the dark side. This speculation implies that the habitability of tidally locked planets depends in part on _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: whether the planet formed at its current orbital distance or migrated inward after forming farther from its star.

B: how the chemical composition of the planet's surface rock affects the absorption of stellar radiation.

C: how many other planets in the same system are also tidally locked to the host star.

D: whether the planet's atmosphere can effectively transfer thermal energy across its surface.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage directly states the condition: 'atmospheric circulation strong enough to distribute heat.' The correct answer must restate this condition. D paraphrases it. A introduces orbital migration (unmentioned). B discusses surface rock composition (unmentioned). C is about other planets in the system (irrelevant to this planet's habitability).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: A school district implemented a new reading program that paired struggling fourth-grade readers with trained volunteer tutors for three weekly thirty-minute sessions. After one academic year, students in the program showed an average improvement of 1.4 grade levels in reading proficiency, compared to an improvement of 0.6 grade levels among students who did not participate. However, participation was voluntary, and students who enrolled were those whose parents had actively sought additional support. The study's design therefore makes it difficult to determine whether _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the observed improvement resulted from the tutoring itself or from characteristics of families who chose to enroll their children.

B: the volunteer tutors were more effective when working with fourth-grade students than they would have been with students in other grades.

C: the non-participating students would have shown greater improvement if the sessions had been longer than thirty minutes.

D: reading proficiency is a reliable predictor of later academic achievement across all subject areas.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: This is a classic self-selection bias question. Voluntary enrollment means the treatment group differs from the control group in ways beyond the treatment itself (parental involvement, motivation). A identifies this confound. B, C, and D raise questions the study was never designed to answer--they go outside the study's scope.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: During the late nineteenth century, Japan's Meiji government invested heavily in railroad construction, connecting major cities and ports that had previously been linked only by footpaths and horse-drawn carts. Historians have noted that these railroads did more than accelerate the movement of goods; they also facilitated the rapid spread of newspapers and standardized educational materials to rural areas. What does the text most strongly imply about the effects of railroad expansion in Meiji-era Japan?

A: The railroads were initially unpopular among rural communities because they disrupted established trade networks.

B: The railroads contributed to cultural and intellectual unification across the country, not merely to economic growth.

C: The construction of railroads was the Meiji government's most expensive infrastructure project of the period.

D: Standardized educational materials distributed via railroad replaced locally developed curricula that had been more effective.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage says railroads moved goods AND newspapers/educational materials. The implication goes beyond economics to culture and knowledge. B captures this dual effect. A introduces unpopularity (unmentioned). C makes a superlative claim ('most expensive') with no support. D makes a quality judgment about curricula that the passage never addresses.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Chemist Lina Ferreira studied a class of synthetic polymers designed to break down in seawater within six months. In laboratory tanks simulating ocean conditions, the polymers degraded on schedule. However, when Ferreira tested the same polymers in actual coastal waters, degradation took nearly fourteen months. Ferreira attributed the discrepancy to the laboratory simulations' failure to replicate certain variables present in natural marine environments, such as fluctuating temperatures and microbial competition. As presented in the text, Ferreira would most likely agree with which statement about the polymer degradation study?

A: The polymers degraded faster in natural seawater than in the laboratory because coastal waters contain a greater density of microorganisms.

B: Laboratory simulations should replace artificial seawater with samples collected directly from the ocean to improve accuracy.

C: The fourteen-month degradation timeline in coastal waters confirms that the polymers are unsuitable for any marine application.

D: Laboratory simulations, while useful, may not fully capture the complexity of real-world ocean conditions.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Ferreira's point is that the lab worked but missed real-world complexity. D restates this. A reverses the finding (polymers were SLOWER in nature, not faster). B proposes a specific fix Ferreira never suggested. C jumps to 'unsuitable for any application'--an absolute the passage does not support.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Art historian Tomas Reyes has argued that the widespread adoption of oil paint in fifteenth-century Europe did not merely offer artists a new medium--it fundamentally altered the kinds of subjects they chose to depict. Because oil paint dried slowly and could be layered to produce subtle gradations of light and shadow, artists could render textures like velvet, glass, and human skin with unprecedented realism. This capability, Reyes contends, encouraged painters to focus increasingly on secular subjects, such as portraits and domestic scenes, where the display of material detail was _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A: dependent on the use of pigments that were unavailable before the fifteenth century.
- B: less important than conveying the spiritual themes favored by religious patrons of the period.
- C: a central artistic objective that the medium's properties were uniquely suited to achieve.
- D: a technique that earlier painters working in tempera had already fully mastered.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage builds toward showing that oil paint's realism made secular subjects attractive BECAUSE those subjects reward material detail. The blank must say that material detail was important/central in secular art. C completes this logic. A introduces pigment availability (off-topic). B contradicts the passage's claim. D contradicts 'unprecedented realism.'

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Sociologist Karen Whitfield found that in a survey of 2,000 urban commuters, those who reported walking or cycling to work also reported higher levels of daily energy and lower levels of stress compared to those who commuted by car. Whitfield cautioned, however, that the survey measured correlation rather than causation. Some critics have noted that the active commuters in the survey tended to live in neighborhoods with lower crime rates, shorter commute distances, and more green space. Which statement, if true, would most directly support the critics' concern about Whitfield's findings?

A: Walking and cycling are known to release endorphins, which have been scientifically linked to improved mood and reduced stress in controlled studies.

B: Commuters who live in neighborhoods with abundant green space and low crime report higher well-being regardless of how they commute.

C: The proportion of active commuters in the survey was roughly consistent with national averages for urban areas of similar size.

D: Several participants switched from car commuting to cycling during the study period and reported modest improvements in energy levels.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: The critics say neighborhood factors (green space, low crime) could explain the results instead of commuting mode. B supports this by showing that those neighborhood features predict well-being REGARDLESS of commute method. A actually undermines the critics by supporting a causal link. C is about representativeness (irrelevant to confounding). D weakly supports causation, not the critics.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Sound travels faster through water than through air because water molecules are packed more closely together, allowing vibrations to transfer more efficiently from one molecule to the next. Engineers designing underwater communication systems exploit this property by using acoustic signals rather than radio waves, which are rapidly absorbed by seawater. The choice to use acoustic signals in underwater systems therefore reflects the fact that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the physical properties of water make it a more effective medium for transmitting sound than for transmitting radio waves.

B: acoustic signals carry more information per second than radio waves do in any medium.

C: sound waves maintain a constant speed regardless of the density of the medium through which they travel.

D: radio waves travel at the same speed in seawater as they do in air but lose signal strength more quickly underwater.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Two facts: (1) water transmits sound well, (2) water absorbs radio waves. The conclusion must combine both. A does this. B makes a universal claim about information capacity (unsupported). C contradicts the passage (speed depends on medium density). D says radio speed is the same in water and air--the passage does not claim this, and the issue is absorption, not speed.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from a 1927 short story by Esme Caldwell. The narrator describes her grandmother's garden. My grandmother tended her roses the way a conductor leads an orchestra--not through force, but through an exquisite attention that summoned each bloom into its fullest expression. She never explained what she was doing or why; I simply understood, watching her hands move among the thorns without hesitation, that expertise could look indistinguishable from tenderness. What does the text most strongly imply about the narrator's view of her grandmother?

A: The narrator admires her grandmother's gardening skill but wishes she would share her specific techniques and reasoning.

B: The narrator believes her grandmother's gardening abilities have declined from what they were in earlier years.

C: The narrator finds her grandmother's refusal to provide instruction to be an expression of deliberate secrecy.

D: The narrator sees her grandmother's practiced expertise as graceful and intuitive rather than mechanical or forced.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The key image is 'not through force, but through exquisite attention' and 'expertise could look indistinguishable from tenderness.' This portrays skill as effortless grace. D captures this. A adds a wish to learn that the passage does not express. B introduces decline (not mentioned). C assigns 'deliberate secrecy'--the passage says the grandmother 'never explained,' but the narrator does not frame this as secretive.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: In the fifteenth century, the city of Timbuktu in present-day Mali served as a center of Islamic scholarship and trade. The city's Sankore Mosque housed one of the largest libraries in the medieval world, with collections that rivaled those of contemporary European institutions. Despite the library's significance, many of its manuscripts remained unstudied for centuries because they were written in scripts and languages unfamiliar to European scholars who dominated the field of historical research. This situation suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the manuscripts held at Sankore were primarily copies of texts already available in European libraries and therefore offered little new information.

B: European scholars during the medieval period were generally aware of the Sankore library's holdings but considered them irrelevant to their research interests.

C: gaps in scholarly attention can result from linguistic and cultural limitations within the research community rather than from the material's lack of importance.

D: the Sankore Mosque library was more significant as a center of religious worship than as an institution of academic research.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage says the manuscripts went unstudied because of LANGUAGE BARRIERS, not because they lacked value. The conclusion must connect neglect to researcher limitations, not to the material itself. C does this. A claims the texts were copies (contradicts 'rivaled'). B says scholars knew but dismissed them (the passage says 'unfamiliar,' implying ignorance). D recharacterizes the library without textual support.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Ecologist Renata Souza and her team studied how the removal of apex predators from a coastal ecosystem affected populations of mid-level predators and herbivores. After the local extinction of sea otters, populations of sea urchins--a prey species of otters--expanded dramatically and consumed vast stretches of kelp forest. The loss of kelp, in turn, deprived numerous fish and invertebrate species of shelter and food. Souza's findings illustrate a phenomenon ecologists call a trophic cascade, in which the removal of a single species triggers _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the rapid evolution of defensive traits in herbivore populations that are no longer regulated by predation.

B: a chain of ecological disruptions that extend across multiple levels of the food web.

C: the eventual replacement of the removed predator by a functionally similar species from a neighboring ecosystem.

D: an initial decline in biodiversity followed by a period of accelerated species diversification.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: A trophic cascade is defined by its MULTI-LEVEL chain reaction. Otters removed -> urchins increase -> kelp disappears -> fish/invertebrates lose habitat. B describes this chain. A shifts to evolution (wrong timescale). C predicts species replacement (unsupported). D describes a decline-then-recovery pattern the passage never suggests.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Political scientist James Okoro analyzed voter turnout patterns in three democracies and found that countries with compulsory voting laws consistently reported turnout rates above 90 percent, while countries with voluntary voting averaged approximately 60 percent. Okoro cautioned, however, that high turnout in compulsory-voting countries does not necessarily indicate high civic engagement, since voters who are legally required to cast ballots may do so without researching candidates or issues. What does the text most strongly imply about compulsory voting?

A: It produces elected officials who more accurately reflect the policy preferences of the full electorate than voluntary voting does.

B: It discourages citizens from developing genuine interest in political issues because participation feels obligatory rather than voluntary.

C: Countries that adopt compulsory voting consistently produce more informed electorates than countries with voluntary systems.

D: Although it increases the quantity of ballots cast, it may not proportionally increase the quality of democratic participation.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Okoro's caveat creates a gap between QUANTITY (turnout) and QUALITY (engagement). D captures this quantity-quality distinction. A assumes better representation (Okoro warns against this). B goes too far--Okoro says voters MAY not research, not that compulsory voting actively discourages interest. C directly contradicts the passage's caution.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Neuroscientist Ana Vega investigated whether bilingual individuals experience cognitive advantages when switching between tasks. She compared the performance of bilingual and monolingual adults on a task-switching exercise in which participants rapidly alternated between sorting shapes by color and sorting them by size. Bilingual participants completed the exercise with fewer errors but did not complete it faster. Vega proposed that bilingualism may enhance accuracy in task-switching by strengthening the brain's ability to suppress competing responses, even if it does not accelerate processing speed. This proposal suggests that the cognitive advantage of bilingualism in task-switching is best characterized as _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: an improvement in the precision of executive control rather than in the velocity of cognitive processing.

B: a temporary benefit that becomes less pronounced as individuals gain more experience with task-switching exercises.

C: a broad enhancement of cognitive function that extends to memory, attention, and reaction time in equal measure.

D: a result of bilingual participants' greater familiarity with standardized tests rather than a genuine cognitive difference.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The data shows fewer errors (precision) but NOT faster speed. The answer must reflect this specific pattern. A matches: precision yes, speed no. B introduces a temporal decline never mentioned. C overgeneralizes to all cognitive functions--the data shows accuracy only, not memory or reaction time. D dismisses the effect as test familiarity without evidence.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: During the construction of the Hoover Dam in the 1930s, engineers faced the challenge of pouring an unprecedented volume of concrete--enough to build a two-lane highway from San Francisco to New York. If poured as a single mass, the concrete would have generated enough heat during curing to remain dangerously hot for over a century. To solve this problem, engineers divided the dam into individual columns and circulated ice-cold river water through embedded pipes to absorb the heat. The engineers' solution demonstrates that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the chemical composition of concrete used in the 1930s differed significantly from the formulations used in modern construction projects.

B: river water is consistently more effective at absorbing thermal energy than commercially manufactured industrial coolants.

C: large-scale engineering projects sometimes require novel techniques to manage physical processes that would be negligible at smaller scales.

D: dividing the dam into columns was primarily intended to reduce construction costs rather than to address the heat generated during curing.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage shows a problem that exists ONLY because of the project's scale (massive concrete volume = massive heat). The novel solution (columns + cooling pipes) addressed a scale-specific challenge. C captures this. A is about concrete chemistry (off-topic). B makes an unsupported comparison. D contradicts the passage's stated purpose.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Linguist Fatima Khoury studied the phenomenon of code-switching--alternating between two languages within a single conversation--among trilingual speakers in Beirut. Khoury found that speakers did not switch languages randomly; instead, they tended to use Arabic for emotional expressions, French for formal or academic topics, and English for technology-related vocabulary. Khoury argued that code-switching in this community reflects not linguistic confusion but rather a sophisticated sensitivity to the social and contextual associations each language carries. As presented in the text, Khoury would most likely agree with which statement about code-switching among the trilingual speakers she studied?

A: Code-switching occurs because speakers lack sufficient vocabulary in any single language to express certain concepts adequately.

B: The pattern of code-switching Khoury observed is universal across all multilingual communities regardless of the specific languages involved.

C: Code-switching is a developmental phase that trilingual speakers outgrow as they achieve higher proficiency in their dominant language.

D: Speakers' choices about which language to use in a given moment are deliberate and shaped by the contextual associations of each language.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Khoury explicitly rejects the 'confusion' interpretation and instead calls code-switching 'sophisticated sensitivity.' The answer must reflect deliberate, context-driven choices. D does this. A aligns with the 'confusion/deficiency' view Khoury rejects. B overgeneralizes beyond Beirut. C frames code-switching as temporary (Khoury treats it as a stable, skilled practice).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Paleontologist Victor Ramos examined fossilized dinosaur trackways--sequences of footprints preserved in ancient mud--in a region of Patagonia. He observed that trackways belonging to large sauropods consistently appeared alongside, and never overlapping with, trackways belonging to smaller theropods. This pattern, Ramos noted, was consistent across multiple sites spanning several million years. Ramos proposed that the two groups of dinosaurs may have used shared landscapes but at different times--possibly with sauropods moving through open floodplains during the wet season and theropods frequenting the same areas during drier periods. However, Ramos conceded that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the trackways could also be explained by the two groups deliberately avoiding each other in shared space to minimize predation risk, regardless of seasonal patterns.

B: fossilized trackways are generally too distorted by geological processes to serve as reliable evidence of animal behavior.

C: sauropods and theropods were fundamentally unable to coexist in the same ecosystem due to direct competition for identical food sources.

D: the fact that both types of trackways appear at the same sites proves that the two groups routinely traveled together in mixed herds.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: 'Ramos conceded' signals an alternative account he acknowledges. The correct answer must offer a DIFFERENT plausible reading of the same data. A provides one: spatial avoidance rather than temporal separation. B dismisses all trackway evidence (too extreme for a 'concession'). C contradicts the data (they ARE in the same ecosystem). D contradicts the non-overlapping pattern.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Anthropologist Nia Osei studied gift-giving practices in three West African communities and found that the value of gifts exchanged during weddings has increased substantially over the past two decades, even after adjusting for inflation. Osei observed that families often go into debt to meet rising expectations for wedding gifts. She also found that young couples who received more expensive wedding gifts were not measurably happier in their first five years of marriage than those who received more modest gifts. These findings together suggest that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: couples who receive expensive wedding gifts are significantly more likely to experience marital dissatisfaction in the long term.

B: the communities Osei studied have placed declining importance on marriage as a social institution over the past two decades.

C: wedding gift inflation imposes financial costs on families without delivering a proportional benefit to the couples receiving the gifts.

D: the inflation-adjusted value of gifts exchanged at other ceremonial occasions has remained stable during the same period.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Two data points--costs rising + no happiness gain. The conclusion must link both: cost without benefit. C does this. A goes further than the data (passage says no difference, not that expensive gifts cause unhappiness). B introduces declining importance of marriage (unsupported). D extends the finding to other ceremonies (no data provided).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Physicist Hana Takahashi and her team developed a new method for producing thin films of gallium nitride, a semiconductor material used in LEDs and power electronics. Conventional methods require temperatures above 1,000 degrees Celsius and produce films with defect densities of approximately 10^8 per square centimeter. Takahashi's technique operates at only 600 degrees Celsius and yields films with defect densities below 10^6 per square centimeter. Despite these advantages, the process is significantly slower than conventional methods, producing films at roughly one-tenth the rate. For manufacturers considering adopting Takahashi's technique, the decision will likely hinge on _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: whether the improved film quality justifies the reduced production speed for their specific applications.

B: whether gallium nitride will eventually be replaced by a less expensive semiconductor material in the global market.

C: how quickly competing research groups can replicate Takahashi's results using their own conventional equipment.

D: whether the lower operating temperature will allow the process to be performed outdoors in warmer climates.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage sets up a trade-off: better quality vs. slower speed. A manufacturer's decision depends on which factor matters more FOR THEIR USE CASE. A captures this trade-off. B shifts to future material substitution (irrelevant to the current decision). C focuses on competitors (not the manufacturer's own decision). D introduces an absurd application scenario.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from a 1946 essay by literary critic Dayo Abiodun. Abiodun is discussing the novels of a fictional author, Constance Wyatt. Wyatt's admirers praise her dialogue for its uncanny verisimilitude--characters speak, they say, exactly as people do. But this is only half true, and the less interesting half. Wyatt's characters speak as people would if they were suddenly, miraculously articulate about their own confusion. Her genius lies not in mimicry but in clarification: she gives her characters the words that real people feel but cannot find. As presented in the text, Abiodun would most likely agree with which statement about Wyatt's writing?

A: Wyatt's admirers correctly identify realistic speech as the most important element of her literary achievement.

B: Wyatt's achievement is not the realistic reproduction of ordinary speech but the illumination of emotions that ordinary speech fails to express.

C: Wyatt's dialogue is most effective when her characters discuss topics that real people rarely talk about openly.

D: Wyatt's characters are ultimately unrealistic because real people never achieve the level of articulation her characters display.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Abiodun says verisimilitude is 'only half true, and the less interesting half.' The MORE interesting part is 'clarification'--giving characters words real people cannot find. B captures both the rejection of mere mimicry and the emphasis on illuminating unspoken feelings. A endorses the admirers' view that Abiodun partially rejects. C shifts to topic rather than articulateness. D calls the characters 'unrealistic,' but Abiodun frames them as an elevated version of real speech, not an unrealistic one.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 26

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In a 2023 study, marine biologist Kofi Mensah compared the foraging behavior of two populations of bottlenose dolphins--one in a shallow bay and one in the open ocean. Bay dolphins used a technique called 'mud ring feeding,' in which a dolphin swims in tight circles to stir up sediment, trapping fish inside a ring of murky water. Ocean dolphins, by contrast, hunted cooperatively by herding fish into dense clusters near the surface. Mensah noted that juvenile dolphins in each population learned their respective technique by observing and imitating adults. The fact that the two populations use distinct foraging strategies acquired through social learning suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: bay dolphins are genetically predisposed to mud ring feeding and would use this technique even if they were raised among ocean dolphins.

B: the foraging strategies of both populations are less efficient at capturing prey than the solitary hunting techniques used by other dolphin species.

C: open-ocean dolphins would be unable to learn mud ring feeding even if they were relocated to a shallow bay environment.

D: dolphin foraging behavior is shaped not only by innate ability but also by culturally transmitted knowledge specific to each population's environment.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The key evidence is SOCIAL LEARNING (juveniles observe and imitate adults) combined with ENVIRONMENT-SPECIFIC techniques. The conclusion must invoke cultural transmission tied to habitat. D captures both elements. A attributes the behavior to genetics, which contradicts social learning. B makes an unsupported efficiency comparison. C claims inability to learn (too strong--the passage shows dolphins CAN learn through observation).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 27

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Economist Selin Arslan analyzed housing prices in twelve mid-sized cities and found that proximity to newly constructed public transit stations was associated with increased property values within a one-mile radius. However, Arslan also found that the increase was unevenly distributed: properties within a quarter mile of stations experienced price increases of roughly 20 percent, while those between a half mile and one mile saw increases of only 3 percent. Additionally, rental prices in the quarter-mile radius rose by nearly 15 percent, leading some longtime tenants to relocate. Arslan's findings suggest that the benefits of transit investment _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: are distributed equally among all residents living within one mile of new stations, regardless of whether they own or rent their homes.

B: are negligible beyond a quarter mile, indicating that transit stations have a much narrower zone of economic influence than previously assumed.

C: are concentrated among property owners closest to stations and may come at the expense of affordability for nearby renters.

D: primarily benefit renters by providing improved access to transportation, which reduces their overall commuting expenses.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage shows TWO distributional inequalities: (1) owners near stations gain property value, (2) renters near stations face rising rents and displacement. C links both. A contradicts the 'unevenly distributed' finding. B says 'negligible beyond a quarter mile'--the passage shows 3% increase, which is small but not negligible. D says renters benefit, which contradicts the displacement evidence.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 28

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1 Historian Laura Chen argues that the printing press, introduced in Europe by Johannes Gutenberg around 1440, was the primary catalyst for the Protestant Reformation. By making books affordable, the press allowed reformers like Martin Luther to distribute their critiques of Catholic Church practices to a wide audience, undermining the Church's control over religious interpretation. Text 2 Historian Ravi Gupta contends that while the printing press accelerated the spread of reformist ideas, it was not a sufficient cause of the Reformation. Gupta points out that printing technology had existed in East Asia for centuries without producing a comparable religious upheaval, suggesting that the specific social, political, and economic conditions of sixteenth-century Europe were at least as important as the technology itself. Based on the texts, how would Gupta most likely respond to Chen's argument?

A: By maintaining that the printing press had no meaningful impact whatsoever on the spread of reformist ideas in sixteenth-century Europe.

B: By suggesting that Chen's argument overemphasizes the role of technology and underestimates the importance of the broader historical context that made the Reformation possible.

C: By claiming that East Asian printing technology was more technically advanced than Gutenberg's press and therefore should have been more likely to produce religious change.

D: By asserting that Martin Luther's personal charisma, rather than either technology or social conditions, was the decisive factor in the Reformation's success.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Gupta does NOT deny the press's role--he says it 'accelerated' ideas but was 'not sufficient.' His counterargument adds CONTEXT as a co-cause. B captures this: technology overemphasized, context underestimated. A is too extreme (Gupta acknowledges the press helped). C misrepresents the East Asian comparison. D introduces 'charisma,' which neither text discusses.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 29

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Mycologist Ingrid Holm discovered that a species of fungus growing on the roots of birch trees in Scandinavian forests produces a compound that inhibits the growth of a common bacterial pathogen. In laboratory experiments, extracts of the fungus reduced bacterial colony formation by 87 percent. However, when Holm tested the compound on infected plant tissue, the reduction was only 34 percent. Holm hypothesized that other microorganisms present on the plant tissue may interact with the compound in ways that diminish its antibacterial effectiveness. This hypothesis suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the compound is unlikely to have any practical applications in either agriculture or medicine.

B: the fungus produces the antibacterial compound only when it is growing in direct association with birch tree roots.

C: laboratory experiments routinely overestimate the real-world effectiveness of all naturally derived antibacterial compounds.

D: the antibacterial properties of the compound may be modulated by the complex microbial communities found in natural environments.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Holm's hypothesis specifically identifies OTHER MICROORGANISMS on the tissue as the source of reduced effectiveness. D paraphrases this: microbial communities modulate the compound's properties. A jumps to 'no applications' (unjustified). B claims production is limited to birch roots (unrelated to effectiveness). C universalizes to ALL compounds (overstatement).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 30

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In a study of workplace productivity, organizational psychologist Miguel Torres asked employees at a technology firm to log the number of times they were interrupted by colleagues during focused work sessions. Torres found that employees who were interrupted more than five times per hour reported significantly lower task completion rates and higher levels of frustration. Interestingly, however, employees who were interrupted two to four times per hour reported higher satisfaction than employees who were never interrupted, even though their task completion rates were also lower than those of the uninterrupted group. Torres suggested that moderate levels of interruption may fulfill a social need that outweighs the productivity cost for some workers. What does the text most strongly imply about the relationship between interruptions and employee satisfaction?

A: Satisfaction is determined entirely by the source of the interruption rather than by its frequency.

B: Employees who are never interrupted consistently report the highest levels of both productivity and satisfaction.

C: The relationship is nonlinear: moderate interruptions are associated with higher satisfaction than either very frequent or zero interruptions.

D: Employees who are interrupted more than five times per hour are the least productive but most socially connected workers in the firm.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Three data points form a curve--zero interruptions (lower satisfaction), 2-4 interruptions (highest satisfaction), 5+ interruptions (lowest satisfaction). This is a nonlinear/inverted-U pattern. C describes it. A says source matters (the passage only discusses frequency). B contradicts the data (uninterrupted workers had LOWER satisfaction than moderately interrupted ones). D adds 'socially connected' (unsupported).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 31

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Botanist Clara Engstrom investigated why a species of alpine wildflower produces seeds with an unusually thick outer coating. She hypothesized that the coating protects seeds during extended periods of dormancy in frozen soil. To test this, Engstrom compared germination rates of seeds stored at -20 degrees C for one, three, and five years. After one year, thick-coated and thin-coated seeds germinated at similar rates. After five years, however, thick-coated seeds germinated at a rate of 72 percent, while thin-coated seeds germinated at only 19 percent. Engstrom's results support the hypothesis because they demonstrate that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: thick seed coatings provide a significant survival advantage specifically under conditions of prolonged cold exposure.

B: thin-coated seeds cannot survive any period of freezing temperatures, even one as brief as a single year.

C: seed coat thickness has no measurable effect on germination when seeds are stored at temperatures above freezing.

D: the thick coating's protective function operates immediately upon exposure to cold rather than increasing over time.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The critical evidence is the INTERACTION between coating and TIME. At one year, no difference. At five years, big difference. The coating helps specifically in PROLONGED cold. A captures this. B contradicts the data (thin-coated seeds survived one year at similar rates). C discusses above-freezing temperatures (not tested). D contradicts the data (the advantage emerged over time, not immediately).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 32

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Author Simone Lavalley's novels are often praised for their intricate plots, but Lavalley herself has said in interviews that she considers plot secondary to what she calls 'emotional architecture'--the way a novel arranges and sequences its emotional experiences to create a cumulative psychological effect on the reader. She has cited as an example her decision, in one novel, to place a joyful reunion scene immediately after a devastating loss, not because the plot demanded that sequence but because the juxtaposition intensified the reader's experience of both emotions. As presented in the text, Lavalley would most likely agree with which statement?

A: The emotional structure of a novel can be as deliberately crafted as its narrative events and may even take priority over plot logic.

B: A novel's plot should always be completely abandoned in favor of emotional sequencing when the two are in conflict.

C: Readers generally prefer novels with complex, suspenseful plots over novels that prioritize emotional resonance.

D: The juxtaposition of joy and grief is the only technique available to novelists seeking to intensify emotional impact.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Lavalley says plot is 'secondary' to emotional architecture and gives a specific example. A says emotional structure CAN take priority--this matches 'secondary.' B says 'always completely abandoned' (too extreme--Lavalley says secondary, not irrelevant). C attributes a preference to readers that contradicts Lavalley's own priorities. D says joy/grief juxtaposition is the 'only' technique (Lavalley cited it as AN example, not THE only one).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 33

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Geographers studying desertification in the Sahel region of Africa have documented a pattern in which the removal of deep-rooted trees for agricultural use leads to a decline in groundwater levels. Deep-rooted trees draw water from underground aquifers and release it into the topsoil through a process called hydraulic redistribution. When these trees are cleared, the topsoil dries out, making it increasingly difficult for crops and remaining vegetation to survive. Ironically, the agricultural expansion that drives tree removal may therefore _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A: have no measurable effect on the region's groundwater supply over the long term.
- B: encourage the development of crop varieties that thrive without access to topsoil moisture.
- C: result in the discovery of previously unknown aquifers beneath the cleared land.
- D: ultimately undermine the very agricultural productivity it was intended to enhance.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The word 'ironically' signals that the outcome contradicts the original intention. Clearing trees for farming -> dry topsoil -> crops fail. The irony is that farming expansion HURTS farming. D completes this ironic reversal. A denies any effect (contradicts the evidence). B and C propose beneficial outcomes that would eliminate the irony.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 34

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1 Art conservator Diana Morales advocates for 'minimal intervention' in the restoration of damaged paintings, arguing that restorers should stabilize deteriorating materials but avoid reconstructing missing elements. Morales contends that speculative reconstruction--filling in lost areas based on what the restorer believes the artist intended--inevitably introduces the restorer's own aesthetic judgments and can distort the original work. Text 2 Art conservator Henrik Bjornsson argues that leaving visible gaps in a damaged painting can be just as distorting as speculative reconstruction. Bjornsson points out that a prominent area of damage draws the viewer's attention away from the composition as the artist designed it, and that a carefully executed reconstruction based on thorough research can actually bring the viewer closer to the artist's original vision. Based on the texts, how would Bjornsson most likely respond to Morales's position?

A: By arguing that all forms of restoration inevitably alter the original work and should therefore be avoided entirely.

B: By conceding that reconstruction is unreliable but proposing that digital imaging technology can replace physical restoration completely.

C: By suggesting that leaving damage visible introduces its own form of distortion by disrupting the viewer's experience of the composition as originally designed.

D: By claiming that Morales's approach is appropriate only for paintings created before the fifteenth century and not for more recent works.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Bjornsson's core argument is that visible damage IS ALSO distorting. He reframes the debate: it is not 'reconstruct and risk distortion' vs. 'leave alone and preserve authenticity,' but rather two types of distortion. C captures this reframing. A goes further than Bjornsson (he supports careful reconstruction). B introduces digital imaging (not in the text). D introduces a time-period distinction (not in the text).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 35

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Astronomer Kenji Fujimoto studied a class of stars known as red giants that exhibit unexpected fluctuations in brightness. Conventional models predict that red giants should dim and brighten in regular, predictable cycles as their outer layers expand and contract. Fujimoto, however, documented several red giants whose brightness patterns were erratic, with sudden flares followed by prolonged dimming. He proposed that these anomalies could be caused by large convective cells--massive upwellings of hot gas from the star's interior--that temporarily disrupt the regular pulsation cycle. Which statement, if true, would most strongly support Fujimoto's proposal?

A: Red giants with erratic brightness patterns are found exclusively in star systems that contain at least one other stellar companion.

B: Computer simulations of large convective cells in stellar interiors produce brightness fluctuations that closely match the irregular patterns Fujimoto observed.

C: The majority of red giants observed by other astronomers display the regular pulsation cycles predicted by conventional models.

D: Red giants with erratic brightness have significantly different surface chemical compositions from red giants with regular brightness cycles.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: To support Fujimoto's proposal, the evidence must connect convective cells to the specific brightness pattern he observed. B does this by showing simulations of his proposed mechanism produce matching results. A suggests a companion star (alternative cause). C supports the conventional model (irrelevant to Fujimoto's outliers). D suggests chemical composition as the cause (alternative mechanism).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 36

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Nutritional scientist Amara Obi examined the effects of soil mineral content on the nutritional profiles of leafy green vegetables. She grew identical cultivars of spinach in soils with varying concentrations of iron and zinc. Plants grown in iron-rich soil contained 40 percent more iron per gram of leaf tissue than those grown in standard soil, but showed no increase in zinc content--even when zinc was also present in elevated amounts. Obi proposed that spinach plants possess selective uptake mechanisms that respond differently to each mineral. Obi's proposal implies that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: increasing the iron content of soil will reliably increase the iron content of all crop species grown in that soil.

B: iron and zinc compete for the same molecular absorption pathways within spinach root systems.

C: spinach is the only vegetable species that possesses selective mineral uptake mechanisms.

D: enriching soil with a particular mineral will not necessarily increase the plant's absorption of that mineral.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The data shows iron was absorbed but zinc was NOT, even when zinc was abundant. This means adding a mineral to soil does not guarantee uptake--it depends on the plant's selective mechanisms. D captures this. A overgeneralizes to all crops. B proposes a specific mechanism (competition) that contradicts 'selective' (each mineral is handled differently). C claims spinach is unique (unsupported).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 37

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Historian Tomoko Nishida argues that the popular narrative of Japan's rapid industrialization during the Meiji era (1868-1912) often overlooks the contributions of rural textile workers, most of whom were women. While accounts of the period typically emphasize the construction of railroads, steel mills, and shipyards, Nishida points out that silk and cotton exports--produced largely by female labor in rural workshops--generated much of the foreign currency that financed those industrial projects. Nishida therefore contends that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: Japan's industrialization would have proceeded at the same pace even without the revenue generated by textile exports.

B: the standard narrative of Meiji industrialization should be expanded to acknowledge the foundational role of rural women's labor.

C: rural textile production during the Meiji era was technologically more sophisticated than the railroad and steel industries of the same period.

D: historians have consistently acknowledged the role of women in Japan's industrialization but have disagreed about the relative importance of their contributions.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Nishida's argument has two parts: (1) textile exports FINANCED industrialization, and (2) these exports were produced by WOMEN in RURAL workshops. Her conclusion must call for expanding the narrative. B does this. A contradicts her point (textile revenue was important). C compares technological sophistication (not her argument). D says historians already acknowledge women's role (contradicts 'often overlooks').

END QUESTION

QUESTION 38

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Behavioral ecologist Yusuf Haddad observed that a species of tropical bird called the velvet weaver constructs two types of nests: an elaborate, brightly decorated nest used during courtship displays and a simpler, camouflaged nest where eggs are actually incubated. Haddad noted that males who built more visually striking display nests attracted more mates but experienced higher rates of nest predation on their display nests. Incubation nests, regardless of the builder's display-nest quality, suffered similar predation rates across all males. This pattern suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: males who construct less elaborate display nests are consistently more successful at raising offspring to adulthood than males with elaborate displays.

B: predators are unable to distinguish between display nests and incubation nests based on visual cues alone.

C: the elaborate display nests attract predators, but this cost does not extend to the incubation nests because they are separately located and concealed.

D: display-nest predation has no measurable effect on the overall reproductive success of velvet weavers as a species.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Two nest types, two predation outcomes. Display nests: predation varies with elaborateness (more showy = more predation). Incubation nests: predation is constant. C connects both findings--display nests attract predators, but the concealed incubation nests are unaffected. A assumes less-elaborate males are more successful (not stated). B contradicts the data (display nests get more predation). D dismisses the predation's impact without evidence.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 39

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Philosopher Amira Kassem has argued that the concept of 'authenticity' in food culture is inherently paradoxical. She notes that dishes widely considered authentic--Neapolitan pizza, for instance--are themselves the products of centuries of cross-cultural borrowing and adaptation. Tomatoes, a defining ingredient of Neapolitan pizza, were introduced to Italy from the Americas only in the sixteenth century. Kassem concludes that labeling any cuisine as 'authentic' requires arbitrarily selecting a point in history and treating the dish's form at that moment as fixed, even though _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: most consumers express a strong preference for traditional recipes over contemporary adaptations when dining out.

B: Neapolitan pizza has remained essentially unchanged in its preparation methods since the sixteenth century.

C: the dish was itself the result of ongoing change and cultural exchange both before and after that point.

D: food historians have established widely accepted criteria for determining when a dish qualifies as authentic.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Kassem's paradox is that 'authentic' freezes a moment in a dish's history of continuous change. The blank must restate that the dish was ALWAYS changing. C does this. A shifts to consumer preferences (off-topic). B says the dish was unchanged (directly contradicts Kassem's argument about ongoing adaptation). D says historians agree on criteria (contradicts the 'paradox' framing).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 40

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: In a randomized experiment, psychologist Wei Chen assigned 200 participants to one of two conditions. In the first condition, participants wrote about a personal failure and then read a brief essay arguing that failure is a normal and necessary part of growth. In the second condition, participants wrote about a personal failure but received no follow-up essay. When asked to attempt a challenging puzzle one week later, participants in the first condition persisted for an average of 14 minutes, compared to 9 minutes for participants in the second condition. Chen concluded that reframing failure as constructive can increase subsequent persistence. Which statement, if true, would most directly weaken Chen's conclusion?

A: Participants in the first condition happened, by random chance, to score significantly higher on a pre-study measure of dispositional persistence than participants in the second condition.

B: Participants in both conditions reported similar levels of emotional discomfort when writing about their personal failures.

C: Participants in the first condition reported finding the puzzle more enjoyable than participants in the second condition did.

D: A small number of participants in the first condition reported that they did not finish reading the follow-up essay before the session ended.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: To weaken a causal conclusion, find an alternative cause. Chen says the ESSAY caused more persistence. A shows the groups were NOT equivalent at baseline--the first group was already more persistent by disposition. This undermines the causal claim. B supports equal starting conditions (does not weaken). C is consistent with reframing working (does not weaken). D weakens only slightly and for a few participants.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 41

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Urban planner Sofia Delgado studied three cities that had converted former industrial waterfronts into public parks. In each city, residential property values within a half mile of the new park increased by an average of 12 percent within five years. Delgado noted, however, that the increase was accompanied by a 30 percent rise in rental prices in the same areas, leading to significant displacement of low-income residents. She argued that cities planning similar projects should pair waterfront redevelopment with affordable housing protections. Delgado's argument most directly implies that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A: waterfront parks provide fewer recreational benefits to urban residents than parks located in non-waterfront areas.
- B: the economic benefits of urban park development can produce inequitable outcomes if not accompanied by policy safeguards.
- C: low-income residents do not value access to public parks and therefore do not benefit from waterfront redevelopment.
- D: cities should avoid converting industrial waterfronts into public spaces under any circumstances.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Delgado does NOT oppose park development--she recommends pairing it with housing protections. Her argument is about EQUITY, not about whether parks are good. B captures this: benefits exist but are distributed inequitably without safeguards. A compares park types (off-topic). C claims low-income residents do not value parks (unsupported and contradicts displacement concern). D is too extreme.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 42

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Entomologist Rosa Martinez discovered that a species of beetle native to cloud forests in Costa Rica uses a combination of chemical and acoustic signals to attract mates. Males produce a pheromone that draws females to a general area, then generate a species-specific clicking sound by rubbing their wing covers together. Martinez found that females consistently chose males whose clicks were louder and more rhythmically regular, even when the pheromone signals of competing males were equally strong. This finding implies that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: pheromone signals play no meaningful role in mate selection for this beetle species and could be eliminated without affecting reproductive success.

B: female beetles of this species are unable to detect pheromone signals at distances greater than one meter from the source.

C: males with louder clicks produce pheromones that are chemically distinct from those produced by males with quieter clicks.

D: acoustic signals serve as a secondary selection criterion that allows females to discriminate among males once pheromones have attracted them to the same area.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage describes a TWO-STAGE system: (1) pheromones attract females to the area, (2) clicks determine which male is chosen. D describes this layered system. A dismisses pheromones entirely (they serve the initial attraction function). B introduces a distance limitation not in the passage. C links click volume to pheromone chemistry (unsupported).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 43

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Archaeologist Samuel Okafor excavated a site in the Niger River valley and uncovered iron smelting furnaces dating to approximately 800 BCE--several centuries earlier than the oldest known iron-working sites in the broader West African region. Some scholars had previously theorized that ironworking technology in West Africa diffused from a single point of origin in the Great Lakes region of East Africa. Okafor's discovery complicates this theory because it _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: confirms that ironworking in the Niger River valley was derived directly from East African techniques that arrived through established trade networks.

B: suggests that West African ironworking may have developed independently rather than originating from a single East African source.

C: demonstrates that the Great Lakes region of East Africa lacked the natural resources necessary for iron smelting before 800 BCE.

D: indicates that iron smelting technology was invented simultaneously on every continent where iron ore deposits were available.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: If the diffusion theory says ironworking spread FROM East Africa TO West Africa, then finding EARLIER ironworking in West Africa undermines that direction of spread. B correctly states the implication: independent development. A supports diffusion (contradicts 'complicates'). C makes a claim about East African resources (not in the passage). D overgeneralizes to every continent.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 44

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Climate scientist Elif Aydin modeled the effects of planting reflective crops--varieties with lighter-colored leaves that bounce more sunlight back into space--on regional temperatures. Her models predicted that replacing standard wheat varieties with reflective cultivars across southern Europe could reduce peak summer temperatures by approximately 1 degree C in agricultural zones. However, Aydin acknowledged that the reflective cultivars currently available produce 8 to 12 percent lower grain yields than standard varieties. For farmers considering a switch, _____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A: the decision will depend on whether the cooling benefits are perceived as sufficient to offset the reduction in crop output.
- B: the reflective cultivars will inevitably prove more profitable because lower temperatures will eliminate the need for crop irrigation.
- C: the temperature reduction would eliminate the need for all other climate adaptation strategies across southern Europe.
- D: the yield difference between reflective and standard varieties is too small to have any measurable impact on farm income.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage sets up a clear trade-off: cooler temperatures vs. lower yields. The correct answer must present this as a judgment call. A does this. B assumes profitability with no supporting data and makes an unsupported claim about irrigation. C says 'eliminate the need for all other strategies' (extreme). D contradicts the passage--8 to 12 percent yield loss is significant.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 45

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1 Musicologist Priya Banerjee argues that the Western classical music canon--the set of works regularly performed by orchestras--has remained largely static for decades, with concerts dominated by the same compositions of Mozart, Beethoven, and Brahms. Banerjee contends that this conservatism reflects institutional inertia and audience expectations rather than any genuine artistic judgment that canonical works are superior to all alternatives. Text 2 Conductor Esteban Rios acknowledges that orchestral programming is repetitive but attributes this to practical constraints rather than inertia. Rehearsal time is limited and expensive, Rios notes, so orchestras tend to program familiar works that musicians can prepare quickly. Introducing unfamiliar pieces requires significantly more rehearsal, which increases costs without guaranteeing comparable ticket revenue. Based on the texts, how would Rios most likely respond to Banerjee's characterization of the orchestral canon's stability?

A: By agreeing that institutional inertia is the primary cause but adding that audience expectations play no role in programming decisions.

B: By suggesting that audiences genuinely prefer canonical works because of their objectively superior artistic quality.

C: By arguing that the orchestral canon has actually changed significantly in recent decades, contrary to Banerjee's claim.

D: By offering an alternative account that emphasizes economic and logistical factors rather than institutional complacency.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Both agree on the observation (canon is static) but DISAGREE on the cause. Banerjee says inertia; Rios says practical/economic constraints. D captures Rios's reframing of the cause. A misrepresents Rios's view. B introduces 'objectively superior' quality (Rios does not make this claim). C disputes the observation itself (Rios agrees programming is repetitive).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 46

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Geneticist Leila Marzouki studied a population of Arctic foxes on an isolated island and found that, despite numbering fewer than 300 individuals, the population maintained higher genetic diversity than expected. Marzouki discovered that females in the population consistently chose mates whose genetic profiles were most dissimilar from their own--a strategy known as disassortative mating. She proposed that this behavioral mechanism acts as a buffer against the loss of genetic diversity that small, isolated populations typically experience. Which statement, if true, would most strongly support Marzouki's proposal?

A: Arctic fox populations on the mainland, which number in the thousands, also exhibit disassortative mating behavior.

B: The island population has experienced several severe weather events that temporarily reduced its numbers below 100 individuals.

C: Computer simulations show that small populations practicing disassortative mating retain significantly more genetic diversity over time than equivalently sized populations mating at random.

D: Female Arctic foxes in the island population also select mates based on territory size in addition to genetic dissimilarity.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Marzouki claims disassortative mating BUFFERS against diversity loss in small populations. To support this, you need evidence that this mating strategy actually preserves diversity better than random mating in small groups. C provides exactly this via simulation data. A shows mainland foxes do it too (does not prove it helps small populations). B adds a bottleneck detail (does not link mating to outcome). D introduces territory selection (tangential).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 47

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from a 1934 novel by Claudette Moreau. The narrator, Lucien, is a schoolteacher reflecting on a former student. I had always assumed that Bernard's silence in class was the silence of incomprehension--the blank stillness of a mind that had simply stopped reaching for the answer. Years later, reading his extraordinary first novel, I understood my error. His silence had been the silence of a mind so crowded with ideas that speech seemed a grotesque reduction. He had not failed to think; he had failed only to find any thought small enough to fit inside a sentence spoken aloud in a schoolroom. What does the text most strongly imply about Lucien's earlier assessment of Bernard?

A: Lucien correctly identified Bernard as exceptionally gifted but deliberately chose not to intervene because he believed the student would eventually find his own voice.

B: Lucien mistook Bernard's intellectual richness for intellectual deficiency.

C: Lucien encouraged Bernard to speak more often in class but was unable to overcome the student's deeply ingrained shyness.

D: Lucien recognized Bernard's potential at the time but lacked the institutional resources to provide him with appropriate support.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Lucien says 'I understood my error.' His error was assuming silence = incomprehension, when silence actually = too many ideas for speech. B captures this reversal: richness misread as deficiency. A, C, and D all assume Lucien recognized Bernard's abilities at the time, which contradicts 'I understood my error' (he did NOT recognize it then).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 48

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Public health researcher Dara Kimani studied the effectiveness of a text-message reminder system designed to improve medication adherence among patients with chronic conditions. Patients who received daily text reminders took their medications on schedule 78 percent of the time, compared to 61 percent for patients who received no reminders. However, when Kimani followed up six months after the reminder system was discontinued, adherence rates in the reminder group had declined to 63 percent--nearly identical to the control group's rate. These findings suggest that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: text-message reminders can improve medication adherence while active but may not produce lasting behavioral changes once removed.

B: patients who received text reminders developed worse medication habits than patients who never received reminders at all.

C: the text-message reminder system was too expensive to be practical for sustained, long-term deployment.

D: medication adherence is determined primarily by the pharmacological properties of the medications themselves rather than by patient behavior.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Three data points tell the story: during reminders (78%), after removal (63%), control baseline (61%). The reminder group returned to near-baseline. This shows temporary, not permanent, change. A captures this. B says they developed WORSE habits (63% vs 61%--nearly identical, not worse). C introduces cost (not discussed). D shifts to pharmacology (contradicts the behavioral data).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 49

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Astrophysicist Mei-Ling Zhou and her team analyzed the orbital mechanics of a binary star system in which a smaller, dimmer companion star orbits a larger primary at an unexpectedly close distance. Conventional models predict that at such proximity, tidal forces from the primary should gradually strip material from the companion's outer layers, causing the companion to lose mass over time. However, Zhou's spectroscopic measurements showed that the companion's mass has remained stable for at least the past three million years. She proposed that a strong magnetic field generated by the companion deflects the tidal forces sufficiently to prevent mass transfer. This proposal would be most weakened if it were demonstrated that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the companion star's magnetic field strength is comparable to that of similar stars in binary systems where mass transfer does occur.

B: the primary star in the system generates a weaker magnetic field than most stars of its size and luminosity class.

C: tidal forces in binary systems are influenced by the orbital eccentricity of the companion's path around the primary.

D: the companion star's surface temperature has fluctuated measurably over the past three million years.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Zhou says the companion's STRONG magnetic field prevents mass transfer. To weaken this, show that having a strong field does NOT prevent transfer. A does this: other companions with similar field strength still lose mass, so the field cannot be the cause. B is about the primary's field (irrelevant to the companion's proposed mechanism). C adds a variable but does not undermine the magnetic field claim. D is about temperature, not mass or magnetism.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 50

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Cognitive psychologist Rajan Mehta investigated the 'illusion of explanatory depth'--the tendency for people to believe they understand complex systems more thoroughly than they actually do. Mehta asked participants to rate their understanding of everyday devices such as zippers and flush toilets on a scale from 1 to 7. Then he asked them to write detailed, step-by-step accounts of how each device works. After writing their accounts, participants re-rated their understanding, and their scores dropped by an average of 2.3 points. Mehta noted, however, that the drop was significantly smaller for participants who had professional experience with mechanical devices, even when those participants' initial ratings were equally high. This finding suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the illusion of depth is primarily driven by overconfidence rather than by a genuine lack of knowledge about how devices function.

B: participants with professional experience were reluctant to lower their self-ratings because their professional identity was tied to mechanical competence.

C: professional experience provides genuine understanding that partially withstands the challenge of articulating a detailed account, whereas non-experts' confidence is more superficial.

D: writing detailed step-by-step accounts is not a valid method for measuring actual understanding of mechanical devices.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Both groups started with equally high ratings, but professionals dropped LESS. This means professionals' confidence was more justified--backed by real knowledge. C captures this: real knowledge vs. superficial confidence. A says overconfidence drives it, but professionals were equally confident yet less wrong (so it is not just confidence). B attributes the smaller drop to pride rather than knowledge (the passage does not support this). D dismisses the method (undermines the entire study).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 51

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1 Sociologist Amara Diallo argues that the decline of local newspapers in the United States has weakened democratic accountability. She points to research showing that municipalities that have lost their local newspaper experienced increases in government spending, bond issuance costs, and instances of public corruption. Diallo contends that local journalists serve as watchdogs whose presence alone deters governmental misconduct. Text 2 Media scholar Jonas Eriksson cautions against overstating the watchdog effect of local newspapers. Eriksson notes that many of the municipalities studied in the research Diallo cites were experiencing economic decline before their newspapers closed--conditions that independently increase government spending and corruption. The loss of the newspaper, Eriksson argues, may be a symptom of the same economic deterioration rather than a cause of democratic dysfunction. Based on the texts, the author of Text 1 would most likely respond to the argument in Text 2 by making which of the following claims?

A: Economic decline in municipalities has no relationship whatsoever to changes in government spending or levels of public corruption.

B: The closure of local newspapers is caused exclusively by shifts in reader preferences and is never linked to local economic conditions.

C: Local newspapers rarely investigate or report on government misconduct and therefore cannot function as meaningful deterrents.

D: Even if economic conditions contribute to the observed outcomes, the independent deterrent effect of local journalism should not be discounted, as municipalities with surviving newspapers in similar economic conditions show better governance metrics.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Diallo would not deny economic factors entirely (that would be extreme). Instead, she would argue that newspapers have an INDEPENDENT effect ON TOP OF economic conditions. D does this by acknowledging Eriksson's point while defending the newspaper's unique role. A and B are too extreme. C contradicts Diallo's own argument about watchdog journalism.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 52

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Neuroscientist Lena Hoffmann examined how the brain processes ambiguous visual stimuli. She presented participants with images that could be interpreted as either a duck or a rabbit, depending on the viewer's perspective. Using functional MRI, Hoffmann observed that participants who perceived the image as a duck showed heightened activity in brain regions associated with processing round shapes, while those who perceived a rabbit showed activation in regions associated with processing elongated forms. Crucially, when participants were informed that both interpretations were possible and asked to switch their perception, the pattern of brain activity shifted to match the new interpretation. Hoffmann's findings imply that ____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the brain's initial interpretation of an ambiguous image is fixed at the moment of first exposure and resists modification through conscious effort.

B: ambiguous visual stimuli activate identical neural pathways regardless of which interpretation the viewer adopts.

C: conscious awareness can redirect the brain's perceptual processing, causing the same physical stimulus to activate different neural regions depending on the intended interpretation.

D: the duck-rabbit illusion is perceived in the same way by all viewers regardless of prior experience or cultural background.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The crucial finding is that ASKING participants to switch their perception CHANGED their brain activity patterns. Same image, different neural response based on conscious intent. C captures this: conscious awareness redirects processing. A says the interpretation is fixed (contradicted by the switch). B says identical pathways (contradicted by different activation patterns). D makes a universal claim about perception that the study does not test.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 53

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Economist Nadia Petrova studied the labor market effects of automating routine tasks in a large financial services firm. Over a three-year period following the introduction of automated document-processing software, the firm eliminated 40 percent of its clerical positions. However, the number of employees in analytical and client-facing roles increased by 25 percent during the same period, and the firm's total employment declined by only 12 percent. Petrova observed that many displaced clerical workers were retrained for the new analytical positions, but those who lacked college degrees were significantly less likely to be selected for retraining. Petrova's observation suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: automation uniformly benefits all workers within an organization by creating positions that are more intellectually stimulating than those it eliminates.

B: the financial services firm should have automated its analytical functions rather than its clerical functions to achieve more equitable outcomes.

C: workers without college degrees are inherently less capable of performing analytical tasks than workers who hold degrees.

D: the net employment effects of automation may be moderate overall, but the distribution of those effects is uneven, with less-educated workers bearing a disproportionate share of the displacement costs.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Two levels of analysis here: (1) overall, the firm lost only 12% of jobs (moderate net effect), (2) within that, non-degree workers were disproportionately left out of retraining. D captures both levels. A says 'uniformly benefits all' (contradicted by the education gap). B prescribes a different strategy (not implied by the data). C conflates selection for retraining with inherent capability.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 54

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Paleoclimatologist Jin-Woo Park analyzed ice cores from Greenland to reconstruct atmospheric methane concentrations over the past 12,000 years. He found that methane levels remained relatively stable from 10,000 BCE to about 3,000 BCE, then began a gradual, sustained rise that continued until the industrial era. Park noted that this inflection point coincided approximately with the expansion of rice agriculture in East and Southeast Asia--a practice that involves flooding fields, creating anaerobic conditions ideal for methane-producing microorganisms. However, some critics argue that natural wetland expansion, driven by climatic changes during the same period, could account for the methane increase without invoking human activity. Park responded by pointing out that the climatic conditions associated with wetland expansion were present at similar levels during earlier periods of the Holocene when methane concentrations did not rise, suggesting that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: natural wetland expansion is the sole driver of the methane increase observed after 3,000 BCE and human rice agriculture played no role.

B: climatic conditions alone are insufficient to account for the post-3,000 BCE rise, which is more consistent with an anthropogenic source such as rice cultivation.

C: methane-producing microorganisms were not present in natural wetlands before 3,000 BCE and therefore could not have contributed to earlier methane levels.

D: ice core records from Greenland are unreliable indicators of global atmospheric methane concentrations during the early Holocene.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Park uses a control period: SAME climate conditions existed earlier, but methane did NOT rise then. This means climate alone cannot cause the rise--something new (rice agriculture) must explain the post-3,000 BCE change. B captures this logic. A supports the critics' view (opposite of Park's argument). C makes a claim about microbial presence (not in the passage). D undermines Park's own evidence.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 55

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from a 1952 essay by philosopher Tadeo Villanueva. We speak of 'discovering' mathematical truths as though they existed before us, waiting in some timeless vault for the right mind to stumble upon them. But consider: no one says we 'discover' a symphony or a legal code. These are made, not found, and mathematics may be no different. The integers, the theorems, the proofs--all may be human artifacts dressed in the costume of necessity, their apparent inevitability a trick of habit rather than evidence of a mind-independent reality. As presented in the text, Villanueva would most likely agree with which statement?

A: Mathematical truths are objectively real and exist in a realm independent of human thought or perception.

B: Mathematics is less rigorous and less reliable than other intellectual disciplines because it is merely a human invention.

C: The widespread belief that mathematics describes a pre-existing reality may reflect a cognitive habit rather than a well-supported philosophical position.

D: Symphonies and legal codes are discovered in the same sense that mathematical theorems are discovered.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Villanueva's analogy: math might be MADE (like symphonies) rather than FOUND. He calls inevitability a 'trick of habit.' C captures this skepticism. A states the exact position Villanueva questions. B says math is 'less rigorous'--Villanueva does not attack rigor, only the metaphysical status. D reverses his analogy (he says math might be made LIKE art, not that art is discovered LIKE math).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 56

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Immunologist Felicia Nakamura studied the effectiveness of a new adjuvant--a substance added to vaccines to enhance the immune response--in elderly patients, who typically mount weaker responses to vaccination. In a clinical trial, elderly patients who received a flu vaccine with the new adjuvant produced antibody levels 60 percent higher than those who received the standard vaccine. However, Nakamura found that the enhanced antibody production declined to levels comparable with the standard vaccine within eight months, while younger patients who received the adjuvant maintained elevated antibody levels for at least fourteen months. Nakamura hypothesized that age-related decline in immune cell function limits the duration of the adjuvant's effect. Which statement, if true, would most strongly support Nakamura's hypothesis?

A: Elderly patients who exercise regularly maintain elevated antibody levels for longer periods than sedentary elderly patients do.

B: Younger patients who received the standard vaccine without the adjuvant also maintained elevated antibody levels for approximately fourteen months.

C: The adjuvant has been shown to enhance antibody production against a wide range of pathogens, not only influenza.

D: Elderly patients in the trial had significantly fewer of the specific immune cells responsible for sustaining long-term antibody production than younger patients did.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Nakamura's hypothesis: age-related immune cell decline limits the adjuvant's duration. To support this, show that elderly patients actually HAVE fewer of these cells. D provides this direct evidence. A introduces exercise (a different variable). B would actually WEAKEN the hypothesis by suggesting younger patients maintain high levels regardless of the adjuvant. C broadens the adjuvant's scope but does not address duration differences.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 57

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Architectural historian Miriam Okonkwo has challenged the common characterization of Brutalist architecture as deliberately hostile to its users. Okonkwo acknowledges that Brutalist buildings--with their exposed concrete surfaces and monumental scale--are frequently criticized as cold and oppressive. However, she argues that many Brutalist architects, particularly those working in post-independence African nations during the 1960s and 1970s, conceived of their designs as expressions of democratic ambition: the massive public plazas and open corridors were intended to accommodate large gatherings and promote communal interaction. Okonkwo contends that the perception of hostility reflects a misreading that conflates the rawness of materials with a rawness of intent. Her argument implies that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: all Brutalist buildings worldwide were designed with the explicit goal of fostering democratic participation and communal assembly.

B: the aesthetic qualities of a building's materials can lead observers to draw incorrect conclusions about the architect's purpose.

C: Brutalist architecture is universally admired by the communities in which it is located because of its democratic associations.

D: the architects of Brutalist buildings in post-independence African nations were entirely unaware of how critics in other countries would perceive their designs.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Okonkwo's key claim: people confuse 'raw materials' with 'raw intent.' This is a material-to-purpose inference error. B generalizes this principle: material aesthetics mislead observers about purpose. A overgeneralizes to ALL Brutalist buildings (Okonkwo says 'many,' 'particularly'). C says 'universally admired' (contradicts widespread criticism). D claims architects were 'entirely unaware' (unsupported).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 58

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Biophysicist Arjun Desai developed a computational model to predict how proteins fold into their three-dimensional shapes. When tested against a database of 500 proteins with known structures, the model correctly predicted the folding pattern of 412 proteins. However, the 88 proteins for which the model's predictions were incorrect shared a common feature: they all contained unusually long regions of intrinsically disordered amino acids--sequences that do not fold into a fixed structure. Desai's model treats all amino acid sequences as converging toward a single lowest-energy configuration, which means it cannot account for regions that remain structurally variable. This limitation suggests that improving the model will require _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: removing intrinsically disordered proteins from the testing database so that the model's accuracy rate appears higher.

B: increasing the total number of proteins in the testing database to reduce the statistical weight of incorrect predictions.

C: incorporating a framework that allows for multiple coexisting structural states within a single protein rather than assuming one fixed configuration.

D: replacing the energy-based approach entirely with a model based solely on the evolutionary history of each protein's amino acid sequence.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The model fails because it assumes ONE fixed structure, but disordered regions have MULTIPLE states. The fix must address this specific flaw: allow multiple structural states. C does this. A and B are statistical tricks that hide the problem rather than fixing it. D proposes a total replacement based on evolutionary history, which is not implied by the passage (the energy approach works for 412/500 proteins).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 59

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1 Literary critic Nkechi Azubuike argues that the unreliable narrator--a narrator whose account the reader has reason to distrust--is the defining innovation of modernist fiction. By embedding uncertainty within the act of storytelling itself, unreliable narration forces readers to become active interpreters rather than passive consumers of plot. Azubuike contends that this technique fundamentally altered the relationship between reader and text. Text 2 Literary critic Oscar Lindqvist counters that unreliable narration predates modernism by centuries. He cites examples from medieval frame tales and eighteenth-century epistolary novels in which the narrator's credibility is explicitly questioned within the text. Lindqvist argues that what distinguishes modernist unreliable narration is not its existence but its subtlety: modernist writers obscure the narrator's unreliability rather than foregrounding it, making the reader's interpretive work more demanding but not categorically different. Based on the texts, Lindqvist would most likely agree with which statement about Azubuike's argument?

- A: Azubuike accurately identifies the interpretive demands of unreliable narration but incorrectly treats a refinement of an existing technique as an entirely new innovation.
- B: Azubuike is correct that unreliable narration originated in modernist fiction but incorrect about the significance of that innovation for readers.
- C: Azubuike overlooks the fact that modernist fiction largely abandoned unreliable narration in favor of other literary techniques.
- D: Azubuike's argument is undermined by evidence that readers of modernist fiction do not actively interpret the texts they read.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Lindqvist agrees unreliable narration is demanding but disagrees that it is NEW. He calls it a subtler VERSION of a pre-existing technique. A captures both the agreement (interpretive demands are real) and the disagreement (refinement, not invention). B concedes originality (Lindqvist does not). C says modernists abandoned the technique (contradicts both texts). D attacks readers' engagement (neither text makes this claim).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 60

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Environmental engineer Thandiwe Moyo investigated the effectiveness of constructed wetlands--artificial marshes designed to filter pollutants from wastewater--in removing pharmaceutical residues. In laboratory-scale wetlands, removal rates for common pharmaceuticals exceeded 90 percent. In full-scale constructed wetlands serving actual communities, however, removal rates averaged only 55 percent. Moyo identified two factors contributing to the discrepancy: full-scale systems process much larger and more variable volumes of water, and they are exposed to seasonal temperature fluctuations that affect the microbial communities responsible for breaking down pharmaceutical compounds. Moyo's findings imply that ____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: constructed wetlands should be replaced entirely by chemical water treatment methods that are unaffected by temperature changes.

B: microbial communities in constructed wetlands function identically regardless of seasonal temperature variation.

C: pharmaceutical residues in community wastewater pose no significant risk to public health or aquatic ecosystems.

D: the performance gap between laboratory and full-scale systems reflects challenges of scale and environmental variability that controlled laboratory conditions do not replicate.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: Moyo identifies TWO specific factors (volume variability + temperature fluctuations) that exist at full scale but not in labs. The conclusion must connect the performance gap to these real-world factors. D does this. A prescribes abandoning wetlands (too extreme). B directly contradicts the findings (temperature DOES affect microbes). C dismisses pharmaceutical risk (unrelated to Moyo's findings about removal rates).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 61

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Historian Claudia Ferrante documented a little-studied episode in which sixteenth-century Venetian glassmakers on the island of Murano were prohibited by law from leaving the republic. The Venetian Senate imposed these restrictions because the glassmakers possessed trade secrets--particularly the formula for cristallo, an exceptionally clear glass--that were commercially invaluable. Ferrante argues that the restrictions were not purely protective; they also reflected an emerging concept of intellectual property in which technical knowledge was treated as a state asset. However, she notes that several glassmakers did flee to other European cities, suggesting that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the Venetian Senate's restrictions successfully prevented the spread of cristallo production techniques across Europe.

B: glassmakers in other European cities had independently developed methods for producing cristallo before the Venetian restrictions were enacted.

C: the commercial value of the glassmakers' knowledge created incentives powerful enough to motivate individuals to defy legal prohibitions and accept personal risk.

D: the Venetian Senate's concept of intellectual property was identical in its legal structure to modern patent law.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage says glassmakers FLED DESPITE legal prohibition. The conclusion must explain WHY they would take such a risk. C provides the incentive: the knowledge was so commercially valuable that the financial reward outweighed the legal danger. A says restrictions succeeded (contradicted by the fleeing). B introduces independent development (does not explain why they fled). D makes a modern legal comparison (unsupported).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 62

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Developmental psychologist Yuki Tanaka studied how children between the ages of four and six understand the concept of fairness. She presented children with a scenario in which two puppets had performed unequal amounts of work and then gave the children a set of stickers to distribute between the puppets. Four-year-olds overwhelmingly divided the stickers equally regardless of work performed. Six-year-olds, however, tended to give more stickers to the puppet that had worked harder--but only when the scenario was described as involving 'earned rewards.' When the stickers were described simply as 'gifts,' six-year-olds also divided them equally. Tanaka's findings suggest that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: children younger than four have no concept of fairness whatsoever and distribute resources randomly.

B: the concept of fairness is entirely culturally determined and varies dramatically across different societies.

C: six-year-olds are incapable of distributing resources equally regardless of how the distribution scenario is framed.

D: the development of merit-based fairness reasoning in children is not merely age-dependent but is also activated by contextual framing that signals an earned-reward scenario.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The key finding is the INTERACTION between age and framing. Six-year-olds used merit ONLY when told stickers were 'earned rewards,' not when told they were 'gifts.' So merit reasoning requires BOTH developmental readiness AND contextual framing. D captures both conditions. A goes below the age range studied. B invokes culture (not tested). C says six-year-olds CANNOT divide equally (contradicted by the 'gifts' condition where they did).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 63

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1 Epidemiologist Grace Liang published a study concluding that outdoor air pollution is a more significant risk factor for childhood asthma than indoor air quality. Liang's study tracked 3,000 children in ten cities over five years and found that children living in areas with higher concentrations of nitrogen dioxide, an outdoor pollutant primarily from vehicle emissions, were 2.4 times more likely to develop asthma than children in low-pollution areas, even after controlling for household factors such as smoking, pet ownership, and housing age. Text 2 Pediatric researcher Carlos Medina argues that Liang's study, while rigorous, may underestimate the role of indoor air quality. Medina notes that the study controlled for known indoor pollutant sources but did not measure actual indoor air pollutant concentrations. He points out that volatile organic compounds (VOCs) from building materials, cleaning products, and cooking can accumulate to high concentrations indoors--often exceeding outdoor levels--and that some of these compounds are known respiratory irritants. Without direct measurement of indoor VOC levels, Medina argues, the study cannot conclusively attribute the elevated asthma risk solely to outdoor pollution. Based on the texts, how would Medina most likely characterize Liang's study?

A: The study is fundamentally flawed because it relies entirely on self-reported data about childhood asthma diagnoses rather than clinical records.

B: The study's controls for indoor air quality, while reasonable, may not fully capture indoor pollutant exposure, potentially inflating the apparent contribution of outdoor pollution.

C: The study's sample size of 3,000 children is too small to produce statistically meaningful results about asthma risk factors.

D: The study should have focused exclusively on indoor air quality rather than attempting to compare indoor and outdoor pollution factors.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Medina calls the study 'rigorous' but identifies a specific gap: controlling for sources is not the same as measuring actual concentrations. If unmeasured indoor pollutants contribute to asthma, the study may over-attribute risk to outdoor pollution. B captures this precise critique. A fabricates a flaw (self-reported data) not mentioned. C attacks sample size (Medina calls the study rigorous). D suggests abandoning outdoor comparison (Medina only wants BETTER indoor measurement).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 64

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Evolutionary biologist Keiko Matsuda investigated why certain deep-sea fish species possess functional eyes despite living in perpetual darkness at depths below 1,000 meters, where sunlight never penetrates. She discovered that these fish produce bioluminescent signals--species-specific patterns of light emitted from photophores on their bodies--that serve as a means of identifying potential mates. Matsuda found that the spectral sensitivity of each species' eyes is precisely tuned to the wavelength of its own bioluminescent emissions, allowing individuals to detect conspecifics while remaining largely invisible to predators whose eyes are tuned to different wavelengths. This finding suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the presence of functional eyes in these deep-sea species was maintained by natural selection because the eyes serve an essential role in species-specific communication.

B: deep-sea fish developed bioluminescence chronologically before they developed functional eyes as a species.

C: all deep-sea organisms that live below 1,000 meters rely exclusively on bioluminescence for both communication and navigation.

D: the eyes of deep-sea fish are structurally identical to those of fish living in sunlit surface waters near the continental shelf.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The puzzle is: why keep eyes in darkness? The answer: eyes detect BIOLUMINESCENT signals for mate identification. Natural selection maintained eyes because they are useful for this communication function. A connects maintenance of eyes to their selective advantage. B makes an evolutionary sequence claim (unsupported). C overgeneralizes to ALL deep-sea organisms. D claims structural identity with surface fish eyes (contradicted by the 'precisely tuned' spectral sensitivity).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 65

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Political theorist Aisha Kamara has argued that democratic deliberation--the process by which citizens discuss and debate policy issues--can paradoxically increase political polarization rather than reduce it. Kamara cites studies showing that when groups of like-minded individuals deliberate together, the group's collective position tends to shift toward a more extreme version of the position most members already held, a phenomenon known as group polarization. She contends that many institutional efforts to promote deliberation inadvertently create ideologically homogeneous groups, thus exacerbating the very divisions they seek to resolve. Kamara's argument most directly implies that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: democratic deliberation is inherently harmful to governance and should be discontinued as a method of civic engagement.

B: citizens who participate in any form of deliberation become permanently more extreme in their political views regardless of group composition.

C: the composition of deliberative groups is a critical design variable: deliberation's effects depend on whether participants hold diverse or homogeneous views.

D: group polarization occurs exclusively in democratic societies and has not been observed in countries with authoritarian systems of government.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Kamara does not condemn deliberation itself--she condemns HOMOGENEOUS deliberation. The implication is that WHO participates matters as much as WHETHER deliberation occurs. C captures this: composition is the key variable. A says deliberation is inherently harmful (too extreme). B says ANY deliberation causes permanent extremism (overstated). D limits the phenomenon to democracies (unsupported).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 66

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Geochemist Olga Petrova analyzed the isotopic signatures of sulfur trapped in 2.5-billion-year-old rock formations. She found a pattern of mass-independent fractionation--a specific distribution of sulfur isotopes that occurs only when sulfur-containing gases in the atmosphere are exposed to ultraviolet radiation without being shielded by an ozone layer. Since an ozone layer requires free oxygen to form, the presence of mass-independent sulfur fractionation in these ancient rocks is consistent with the prevailing view that Earth's atmosphere contained negligible oxygen before the Great Oxidation Event approximately 2.4 billion years ago. However, Petrova discovered that rocks dating to just 50 million years before the Great Oxidation Event show a subtle but measurable weakening of the mass-independent fractionation signal. This weakening suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the Great Oxidation Event occurred as a sudden, abrupt transition without any preceding changes in atmospheric composition.

B: ultraviolet radiation levels were significantly higher 2.5 billion years ago than they are at the present time.

C: the mass-independent fractionation method is unreliable for analyzing rocks older than approximately 2 billion years.

D: small but increasing amounts of oxygen may have been accumulating in the atmosphere in the millions of years immediately preceding the Great Oxidation Event.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The chain of logic: mass-independent fractionation = no ozone = no oxygen. WEAKENING of the signal = partial ozone = some oxygen appearing. This suggests a gradual oxygen buildup BEFORE the main event. D captures this. A says 'sudden, no preceding changes' (contradicted by the pre-event signal change). B discusses UV levels (not the point of the weakening signal). C attacks the method's reliability (undermines the entire study).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 67

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Psycholinguist Marco Bellini studied how bilingual speakers resolve lexical ambiguity--situations in which a word has different meanings in two languages. He presented Italian-English bilinguals with the English word 'camera' (a photographic device) and measured how quickly they could identify its meaning. He found that participants took significantly longer to process 'camera' than unambiguous English words, because 'camera' also means 'room' in Italian. Crucially, the processing delay persisted even when participants were tested in an exclusively English-language context with no Italian cues present. Bellini's results imply that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: bilingual speakers activate both languages simultaneously during word processing, even when the context strongly favors only one language.

B: bilingual speakers process all words more slowly than monolingual speakers do in every linguistic context, regardless of whether lexical ambiguity is present.

C: the meaning of a word in one language has no influence whatsoever on how that same word is processed when it appears in the other language.

D: Italian-English bilinguals rely primarily on surrounding sentence context rather than on stored word knowledge to determine the meaning of ambiguous words.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The key evidence is that the delay occurred even WITHOUT Italian cues. If only English was active, 'camera' would not cause interference. The interference means Italian was also activated--both languages run simultaneously. A captures this. B overgeneralizes to ALL words (the effect was specific to cross-language ambiguous words). C directly contradicts the findings. D says bilinguals rely on context, but the study shows interference DESPITE the English-only context.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 68

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1 Ecologist Fatou Diop argues that rewilding--the reintroduction of species to ecosystems from which they have been eliminated--is the most effective strategy for restoring degraded landscapes. Diop points to the successful reintroduction of wolves to Yellowstone National Park, which led to a cascade of ecological benefits, including the recovery of streamside vegetation, reduced soil erosion, and increased biodiversity. Text 2 Conservation biologist Henrik Larsson expresses skepticism about generalizing from the Yellowstone example. Larsson notes that Yellowstone is an unusually large, well-protected reserve with minimal human settlement, conditions rarely replicated elsewhere. In landscapes dominated by agriculture and human habitation, Larsson argues, reintroduced predators frequently come into conflict with livestock and human communities, generating opposition that can undermine the entire conservation effort. He suggests that in such landscapes, habitat restoration without predator reintroduction may achieve more durable ecological gains. Based on the texts, Larsson would most likely agree with which statement about Diop's argument?

A: Diop's argument ignores the documented ecological benefits that resulted from the Yellowstone wolf reintroduction.

B: Diop's argument is sound in principle but insufficiently attentive to the practical constraints that make rewilding difficult or counterproductive in landscapes significantly altered by human activity.

C: Rewilding has never produced measurable ecological benefits in any documented case, including Yellowstone.

D: Habitat restoration is always more effective than rewilding regardless of the landscape's characteristics or level of human modification.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Larsson does NOT deny Yellowstone's success--he questions its GENERALIZABILITY. His concern is about applying the approach to human-dominated landscapes. B captures this: correct in principle, limited in practice by real-world constraints. A says Larsson ignores Yellowstone's benefits (he does not). C denies all benefits (too extreme). D says habitat restoration is ALWAYS better (Larsson says this only for certain landscapes).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 69

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Materials scientist Yara Osman developed a new composite material that combines ceramic fibers with a polymer matrix to create panels that are simultaneously lightweight and impact-resistant. In laboratory drop tests, the panels absorbed 35 percent more impact energy per unit weight than conventional aluminum panels while weighing 40 percent less. However, when Osman subjected the panels to repeated impacts simulating long-term use, she found that the polymer matrix gradually developed microfractures that reduced impact resistance by 50 percent after 200 cycles, whereas aluminum panels showed only a 10 percent decline after the same number of cycles. For applications requiring long-term durability, _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the composite panels will inevitably replace aluminum in all industrial applications within the next decade.

B: aluminum panels are universally superior to composite materials in every measurable performance category.

C: the composite material's microfractures would likely heal spontaneously during periods between impacts.

D: the composite material's superior initial performance may be offset by its faster rate of degradation under repeated stress.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The passage sets up a short-term vs. long-term trade-off. Composite wins on single-impact performance but degrades faster over many impacts. For LONG-TERM applications, the degradation matters. D captures this trade-off. A predicts universal replacement (contradicted by the durability problem). B says aluminum is superior in EVERY category (composite is better on single impact and weight). C invokes self-healing (unsupported).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 70

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Anthropologist Sven Holmgren studied naming practices in a community of indigenous reindeer herders in northern Scandinavia. He found that herders assign individual names to each reindeer in their herd--sometimes numbering several hundred animals--and that these names often encode detailed information about the animal's physical characteristics, lineage, and behavioral tendencies. Holmgren documented that experienced herders could recall over 300 names and the associated information for each, a feat that impressed researchers specializing in expert memory. However, Holmgren cautioned against interpreting this ability as extraordinary in any general cognitive sense, noting that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the herders had received formal training in mnemonic strategies at regional educational institutions during their youth.

B: the naming system itself functions as a mnemonic framework that organizes information in contextually meaningful ways, making the recall less a feat of raw memory capacity than a product of deep domain expertise.

C: herders in other regions of Scandinavia do not assign individual names to their reindeer and instead rely on ear tags and numerical identification systems.

D: the ability to recall 300 names falls well within the normal range of human memory and does not require any specialized knowledge or practice.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Holmgren says the ability is NOT 'extraordinary in a general cognitive sense.' His caution must provide an alternative account. B explains that the naming system itself provides structure--like how a filing system helps recall. The skill comes from expertise, not from exceptional raw memory. A credits formal training (unlikely for indigenous practice). C compares to other groups (does not address the caution). D says 300 names is normal (understates the feat and ignores the associated detail).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 71

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Biochemist Sandra Okello investigated the mechanism by which a soil bacterium, *Streptomyces viridochromogenes*, produces the herbicide bialaphos. She identified a gene cluster encoding the enzymes responsible for assembling the compound through a series of sequential chemical reactions. When Okello inactivated one of the genes in the middle of the cluster, the bacterium accumulated an intermediate compound that is not normally detectable. Unexpectedly, this intermediate compound exhibited potent antifungal properties--a biological activity entirely absent from the final herbicidal product. Okello's discovery implies that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the biosynthetic pathways of microorganisms can generate intermediate compounds with biological activities distinct from those of the pathway's end product, suggesting untapped potential for drug discovery.

B: the herbicidal properties of bialaphos are entirely attributable to the intermediate compound rather than to the final product of the biosynthetic pathway.

C: all soil bacteria produce intermediate compounds with antifungal properties during their normal metabolic processes.

D: gene inactivation invariably results in the accumulation of biologically active intermediate compounds in microbial biosynthetic pathways.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: The key discovery: an intermediate in a known pathway has a DIFFERENT useful activity (antifungal) than the end product (herbicidal). This means biosynthetic intermediates are worth investigating for novel bioactivities. A captures this broader implication. B says the intermediate, not bialaphos, is the herbicide (contradicts the passage). C generalizes to ALL soil bacteria (unsupported). D says gene inactivation ALWAYS produces active intermediates ('invariably' is too strong).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 72

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1 Philosopher of science Rebecca Engel argues that scientific models should be evaluated primarily by their predictive accuracy. A model that reliably predicts experimental outcomes, Engel contends, is scientifically valuable even if its underlying assumptions are known to be false. She cites the continued use of Newtonian mechanics in engineering as an example: although superseded by general relativity, Newtonian mechanics remains indispensable because its predictions are sufficiently accurate for most practical purposes. Text 2 Philosopher of science Dmitri Volkov maintains that predictive accuracy, while important, is insufficient as the sole criterion for evaluating scientific models. Volkov argues that models also serve purposes of understanding--they help scientists comprehend why phenomena occur, not merely predict that they will. A model with high predictive accuracy but false assumptions may generate correct outputs without illuminating the mechanisms responsible for those outputs, leaving scientists unable to anticipate when and how the model will fail. Based on the texts, how would Volkov most likely respond to Engel's example of Newtonian mechanics?

A: By pointing out that Newtonian mechanics is no longer used in any branch of science or engineering.

B: By claiming that Newtonian mechanics and general relativity produce identical predictions in every physical scenario without exception.

C: By arguing that the example actually supports his position, because Newtonian mechanics' false assumptions about gravity prevent it from predicting phenomena like gravitational lensing, illustrating the limitations of prioritizing prediction over deeper understanding.

D: By suggesting that Engel should have used quantum mechanics rather than Newtonian mechanics as her primary example.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Volkov's argument is that false assumptions leave scientists unable to anticipate where a model will fail. Newtonian mechanics DOES fail (e.g., gravitational lensing, Mercury's orbit)--and its false assumptions are WHY. This actually supports Volkov: the example shows the LIMITS of prediction-only evaluation. C turns Engel's example against her. A is factually wrong. B is factually wrong. D is irrelevant quibbling.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 73

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Sociologist Mei Taniguchi studied how the transition from in-person to remote work during a global health crisis affected knowledge sharing among employees at a large consulting firm. Before the transition, junior employees frequently acquired tacit knowledge--unwritten skills and contextual understanding--through informal interactions such as overhearing senior colleagues' conversations, observing their problem-solving approaches, and receiving spontaneous feedback. After the shift to remote work, junior employees reported that their formal skills training continued uninterrupted but that they felt less confident handling ambiguous, nonroutine tasks. Senior employees, by contrast, reported no comparable decline in confidence. Taniguchi's findings suggest that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: formal skills training is more effective than informal interaction for developing competence in complex, nonroutine tasks.

B: knowledge sharing between junior and senior employees ceased entirely during the period of remote work.

C: senior employees benefited more from remote work than junior employees because they preferred working independently.

D: the loss of informal, in-person interaction disproportionately affects less experienced workers whose development depends heavily on the tacit knowledge transmitted through proximity to experts.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Trick: The data shows a DIVERGENCE: juniors lost confidence on ambiguous tasks, seniors did not. The difference is that juniors relied on informal proximity-based learning that remote work eliminated. D captures this: informal interaction loss hurts juniors more because they depend on it more. A contradicts the findings (formal training continued but confidence still dropped). B says 'entirely ceased' (too extreme). C attributes the difference to preference (unsupported).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 74

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Volcanologist Carmen Alvarez studied lava tubes--tunnels formed when the surface of a flowing lava stream cools and solidifies while molten lava continues to flow beneath. She found that lava tubes on the flanks of Mauna Loa in Hawaii extend for distances of up to 50 kilometers, far longer than conventional thermal models predict. These models assume that heat loss through the tube walls should cause the lava to solidify within approximately 20 kilometers. Alvarez proposed that the discrepancy is accounted for by the insulating properties of the solidified tube walls themselves: as the walls thicken, they increasingly prevent heat from escaping, allowing the lava to maintain its fluidity over greater distances. Which statement, if true, would most strongly support Alvarez's proposal?

A: Lava tubes on volcanoes with lower eruption temperatures than Mauna Loa are consistently shorter in length than those found on Mauna Loa.

B: Measurements of tube wall thickness along the length of Mauna Loa's longest tubes show a progressive increase in wall thickness that correlates with reduced heat loss at greater distances from the vent.

C: Lava tubes on Mars, where surface temperatures are far lower than on Earth, are estimated to be shorter than those found on Mauna Loa.

D: The chemical composition of lava within Mauna Loa's tubes is identical to the composition of lava in shorter tubes on other Hawaiian volcanoes.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Alvarez's mechanism: thicker walls = better insulation = less heat loss = longer flow. To support this, show that wall thickness ACTUALLY increases along the tube AND correlates with reduced heat loss. B provides this direct mechanistic evidence. A could be explained by temperature alone. C introduces Mars (a confounded comparison). D shows same chemistry (does not address the insulation mechanism).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 75

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: The following text is adapted from a 1961 essay by cultural critic Helena Varga. Mass literacy, which the reformers of the nineteenth century championed as the ultimate democratic tool, has revealed an irony they did not foresee. The ability to read, once rare and therefore powerful, has become universal and therefore ordinary. What was once a gateway to independent thought is now just as often a gateway to passive consumption: the same skill that enables a citizen to read a political treatise enables her to absorb, without resistance, the language of an advertisement. The reformers were right that literacy would reshape society; they were wrong about the direction. As presented in the text, Varga would most likely agree with which statement?

A: The spread of literacy has had complex consequences, empowering critical engagement for some while also enabling unreflective consumption for others.

B: Mass literacy has failed entirely to produce any of the democratic benefits that nineteenth-century reformers anticipated.

C: Advertisements are the most influential form of written communication in modern democratic societies, surpassing all other genres.

D: Nineteenth-century reformers would have opposed the spread of literacy if they had been able to foresee its full consequences.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Varga says literacy enables BOTH independent thought AND passive consumption ('just as often'). She calls this an irony, not a total failure. A captures this duality. B says literacy 'failed entirely' (Varga says it DID reshape society, just not purely as hoped). C elevates advertisements above all other writing (Varga uses ads as an example, not as a superlative claim). D attributes a hypothetical view to reformers (Varga does not speculate about what they would have done).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 76

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Oceanographer Tariq Hassan used autonomous underwater vehicles to map hydrothermal vent fields along the Mid-Atlantic Ridge. He discovered that vent fields separated by distances of less than 500 meters often harbored species communities with less than 30 percent overlap, while fields separated by 5 kilometers or more sometimes shared over 70 percent of their species. This counterintuitive pattern contradicts the expectation that geographic proximity should predict community similarity. Hassan proposed that the chemical composition of the vent fluid--which varies based on the underlying rock type--exerts a stronger influence on species community composition than geographic distance does. Hassan's proposal implies that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

- A: hydrothermal vent communities are determined primarily by the chemical environment rather than by the organisms' ability to disperse between nearby sites.
- B: all hydrothermal vent fields along the Mid-Atlantic Ridge support identical species communities regardless of their chemical or geographic characteristics.
- C: geographic distance is the sole factor that determines species community composition in all marine ecosystems worldwide.
- D: organisms living at hydrothermal vents are incapable of surviving if transferred to a vent with a different chemical composition.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: Hassan's data shows CHEMISTRY trumps DISTANCE: nearby vents with different chemistry have different species, while distant vents with similar chemistry share species. A restates this: chemistry > dispersal/distance. B says identical communities everywhere (contradicts the variation Hassan found). C says distance is the sole factor (directly contradicts Hassan's finding). D says organisms cannot survive different chemistry (too extreme; the passage discusses community composition, not individual survival).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 77

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1 Education researcher Pavel Novak advocates for the integration of competitive academic contests, such as math olympiads and debate tournaments, into the standard school curriculum. Novak argues that competition motivates students to pursue deeper mastery of subjects and teaches resilience in the face of setbacks. He points to research showing that students who participate in academic competitions score higher on standardized assessments and are more likely to pursue advanced degrees. Text 2 Education researcher Fiona Campbell warns that the research Novak cites suffers from selection bias: students who voluntarily enter academic competitions tend to be higher-achieving and more motivated to begin with, making it difficult to attribute their success to the competitive experience itself. Campbell further argues that embedding competition in the standard curriculum--rather than offering it as an optional enrichment activity--could discourage students who respond poorly to competitive pressure, particularly those from backgrounds where academic risk-taking is less culturally supported. Based on the texts, how would Campbell most likely respond to Novak's claim that competition motivates deeper mastery?

A: By conceding that competition reliably produces deeper mastery for all students regardless of their prior achievement level or personal disposition.

B: By asserting that standardized assessments are not valid instruments for measuring academic mastery or long-term intellectual development.

C: By arguing that the evidence for competition's motivational benefits is confounded by self-selection and that mandating competition could harm the students it is least likely to help.

D: By suggesting that academic competitions should be replaced entirely by collaborative learning activities in which no student experiences failure.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Trick: Campbell makes TWO arguments: (1) the evidence is flawed (selection bias), and (2) mandating competition creates a new risk (discouraging vulnerable students). C combines both. A concedes Novak's claim (Campbell does not). B attacks standardized assessments (Campbell's argument is about selection bias, not assessment validity). D proposes eliminating competition entirely (Campbell's concern is about mandating it, not about its existence as an option).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 78

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Astrophysicist Renata Kuznetsova studied fast radio bursts (FRBs)--intense, millisecond-duration pulses of radio waves originating from outside our galaxy. Most FRBs are one-time events, but a small subset repeat at irregular intervals. Kuznetsova analyzed the timing patterns of a repeating FRB source and found that its bursts occurred in clusters separated by periods of silence lasting 40 to 60 days. She proposed that the source is a highly magnetized neutron star orbiting a companion object, and that bursts occur only when the neutron star passes through a cloud of plasma surrounding the companion. During the periods of silence, the neutron star would be outside the plasma cloud and unable to generate the interaction that produces the bursts. Kuznetsova's model predicts that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the interval between burst clusters should be roughly periodic, corresponding to the neutron star's orbital period around its companion.

B: all fast radio bursts, including those that do not repeat, originate from binary star systems containing magnetized neutron stars.

C: the frequency of individual bursts within each cluster should increase steadily over time as the neutron star's orbit gradually decays.

D: the plasma cloud surrounding the companion object should produce continuous visible-light emissions detectable by ground-based optical telescopes.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Trick: If bursts happen when the neutron star enters the plasma cloud during its orbit, the silence between clusters should match the orbital period (how long it takes to come back around). This would produce a roughly PERIODIC pattern. A captures this prediction. B extends to ALL FRBs (Kuznetsova's model is for this specific repeating source). C predicts increasing frequency (not implied by the orbital model). D predicts visible light from the cloud (not implied).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 79

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Behavioral economist Lena Brandt investigated how the framing of charitable appeals affects donation behavior. She presented 1,200 participants with an appeal for a disaster relief organization. Half the participants received a version emphasizing a single identifiable victim (a named child with a photograph and personal story), while the other half received a version presenting statistical information about the scope of the disaster (number of displaced families, total economic losses). Consistent with prior research on the 'identifiable victim effect,' participants who received the individual story donated an average of 28 dollars, compared with 16 dollars for those who received the statistical version. However, Brandt added a third condition in which participants received both the individual story and the statistics. Surprisingly, donations in this combined condition averaged only 19 dollars--significantly lower than the story-only condition. Brandt proposed that the addition of statistics activates a more analytical mode of thinking that partially suppresses the emotional response evoked by the individual story. Brandt's proposal implies that ____ Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: statistical information about disasters is always less persuasive than individual victim narratives in every context and for every audience.

B: charitable organizations seeking to maximize donations should avoid combining emotional narratives with statistical information in the same appeal.

C: donors who respond generously to individual victim stories are behaving irrationally and should be educated to rely on statistical evidence instead.

D: the identifiable victim effect operates only when the victim described in the appeal is a child rather than an adult.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: The key finding is that COMBINING story + statistics REDUCED donations below story-only. This means mixing the two frames backfires. The practical implication is to keep them separate. B captures this. A says statistics are ALWAYS less persuasive (the study shows a specific interaction, not a universal rule). C calls emotional donors 'irrational' (Brandt does not make this value judgment). D limits the effect to children (the passage does not test adult victims).

END QUESTION

QUESTION 80

SECTION: READING_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Inference & Complete the Text

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Historian Amara Kessler examined the economic effects of the 1854 Reciprocity Treaty between British North America and the United States, which eliminated tariffs on natural resources traded between the two regions. Previous historians had attributed the sharp increase in cross-border trade following the treaty primarily to the tariff reduction itself. Kessler, however, found that trade volumes had already been rising substantially in the years immediately before the treaty was signed, driven by the expansion of railroad networks that connected interior resource-producing regions to ports and border crossings. The treaty's tariff reduction, Kessler argued, amplified an existing trend but was not its primary initiator. By comparing the rate of trade growth before and after 1854, Kessler showed that the post-treaty acceleration, while real, was only modestly greater than what the pre-treaty trend line would have predicted. Kessler's analysis suggests that _____. Which choice most logically completes the text?

A: the Reciprocity Treaty had no measurable effect whatsoever on trade between British North America and the United States.

B: improvements in transportation infrastructure may have been a more fundamental driver of trade growth than the tariff reduction, which added incremental rather than transformative momentum.

C: railroad expansion in the 1850s was itself a direct consequence of the Reciprocity Treaty's tariff reductions rather than an independent development.

D: tariff reductions are always less effective at stimulating international trade than investments in transportation infrastructure, regardless of historical context.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Trick: Kessler does NOT say the treaty had zero effect--she says it 'amplified' an existing trend and the acceleration was 'only modestly greater.' The primary driver was railroads. B captures this nuanced position: infrastructure was more fundamental, tariffs were incremental. A says 'no effect' (too extreme). C reverses causation (railroads came before the treaty). D universalizes to 'always' (Kessler's claim is specific to this case).

END QUESTION